

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 299

By Vital

A RESOLUTION to honor Preserve Chattanooga on the occasion of its fiftieth anniversary.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing a civic organization that has worked diligently for fifty years to preserve Chattanooga's architectural heritage through historic preservation, education, and advocacy; and

WHEREAS, Preserve Chattanooga was founded as Landmarks Chattanooga in 1975 and was known for many years as Cornerstones; no matter the name, the organization is committed to expanding its fifty-year legacy; and

WHEREAS, in its earliest days, the organization, through its board of directors, was instrumental in saving the Walnut Street Bridge, a Chattanooga landmark; and

WHEREAS, today, Preserve Chattanooga provides strategic preservation leadership via building acquisitions and transfers, structural assessment funding, stabilization grants, and impactful partnerships with other agencies and foundations; and

WHEREAS, the Central Block Building, Passenger Freight Depot, Burchay Building, Stong Building, Brown's Tavern, First Congregational Church, Tomorrow Building, Park Place School, Engel Stadium, the Industrial YMCA, and many more historic edifices have benefited from the nonprofit organization's efforts; and

WHEREAS, Terminal Station, The Dome Building, Customs House, and the Trigg-Smartt Building (Tivoli Center) will remain architectural treasures for future generations due to the protective facade easements Preserve Chattanooga has procured for these historic buildings; and

WHEREAS, in addition to providing direct assistance to property owners, neighborhoods, and developers, Preserve Chattanooga utilizes many other tools to promote

preservation in the city, including educational programming, advocacy support, and its Preservation Resource Center; and

WHEREAS, Preserve Chattanooga is now partnering with the Lyndhurst Foundation and the Regional Planning Agency to update the 1977 Chattanooga Preservation Plan, which will include extensive input from the community and become a blueprint for the future; and

WHEREAS, Preserve Chattanooga's grant partners have included the 1772 Foundation, State of Tennessee, Tennessee Arts Commission, and Chattanooga Tourism Company over the years; and

WHEREAS, Preserve Chattanooga annually partners with the University of Tennessee at Chattanooga's (UTC) Interior Architecture and Design program to offer a minor in Historic Preservation; and

WHEREAS, the organization also assists with UTC senior thesis projects that provide neglected historic Chattanooga buildings with adaptive reuse concepts, a partnership that has reached more than 300 students since 2016; and

WHEREAS, Preserve Chattanooga has collaborated with Chattanooga Tourism to make available online self-guided architectural tours for Chattanooga neighborhoods, including the Downtown Historic District, Southside, Stone Fort, Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., District, and the University/McCallie Avenue corridor; and

WHEREAS, Preserve Chattanooga is a member of the National Trust for Historic Preservation, National Preservation Partners Network, Southeast Chapter of the Society of Architectural Historians, and National Alliance of Preservation Commissions; and

WHEREAS, Preserve Chattanooga stays informed of preservation efforts through the Tennessee Historical Commission at the State level and through the Advisory Council on Historic Preservation on the national level; and

WHEREAS, for fifty years, Preserve Chattanooga has collaborated with organizations throughout the Chattanooga community to broaden its mission to preserve the city's architectural heritage, and this exemplary organization is worthy of our approbation on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the leadership, staff, and volunteers of Preserve Chattanooga on the occasion of the organization's fiftieth anniversary and thank them for their ongoing commitment to historic preservation.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.